



RED BANNER ALERT



mainroads
WESTERN AUSTRALIA

SHW Serious Incident (SI) – Preliminary Notice

Date of Incident:	16/02/2023	Time of Incident:	16:00
Directorate / Region:	RMO, Wheatbelt	Main Roads or Contractor:	Contractor
EQSafe Event Type:	Injury/ Illness	EQSafe Incident Number:	30012
Actual Consequence:	Moderate	Potential Consequence:	Major

Incident Short Description:	Fire Ignited from Grinding Activities
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What Happened:
A Worker was tasked with removing formwork from a box culvert end treatment. While undertaking the task the worker attempted to remove a nut from a bar which was retaining a formwork shutter, however due to a burr on the end of the bar the nut could not come free. The worker retrieved a grinder to remove approx. 10mm of the burred end of the bar. Once the end of the bar was removed, the Worker picked up the offcut and as it was hot, released the offcut which unintentionally landed in dry grass/leaf material near the work area. The offcut then ignited a fire. The Worker attempted to control the fire with fire extinguishers and when this was unsuccessful, emergency services (local rural fire services) were contacted, and they mobilised to site to control the fire. In addition to the emergency services arriving onsite, a contingent of nearby farmers also assisted in the control of the fire. During the event, a Traffic Control vehicle was parked across the roadway (with the amber beacons and hazard lights activated) to prevent uncontrolled Member of Public entry to the emergency location. As the fire grew, smoke engulfed the vehicle which obstructed vision for oncoming traffic. A member of public who was coming to assist in extinguishing the fire, struck the TC vehicle at low speed. No TC personnel were in the vehicle at the time of crash. The member of public sustained no injuries. There was also damage sustained to personal property (a passing grain truck, boundary fence, vehicle). Following the incident, one of the traffic controllers reported an injury and was taken to the Wagin hospital. The TC sustained a burn to the right side of their face. The injury required an application of burn cream and dressing. Another TC was treated for suspected smoke inhalation.



Fire damage area (looking East)
Note: the yellow circle shows where the fire started.



Fire damaged area (looking West)

A formal ICAM investigation has commenced. Once completed, the lessons learnt will be communicated/shared through a final Grey Banner Alert as soon as practicable.



This serious potential incident aligns with the Main Roads Critical Risk profile relating to **Ignition Causing Bushfire**.

Immediate Actions:

- Please note that these are generic actions for all to consider in relation to this critical risk (and is not reflective of this specific incident):*
- Review Risk Registers to ensure that hot works have been included, where applicable and controls
 - Review the Emergency Response Management Plan to ensure that Emergency Management Team members have been identified and are aware of their responsibilities
 - Carry out an emergency drill and ensure a post drill brief is held to communicate findings
 - Investigate the telecommunications availability for sites, and identify measures that can be taken where these are unavailable or reduced capacity

Distribution of Notice:

Main Roads Personnel and Contracting Organisations